

DAVID H. NASON

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

West Virginia University

- Postdoctoral Researcher, Regional Research Institute

June 2026 - Present

Florida Gulf Coast University

- Postdoctoral Research Associate, Regional Economic Research Institute
- Adjunct Instructor, Department of Economics and Finance

May 2025 - May 2026

January 2026 - May 2026

EDUCATION

West Virginia University

May 2025

Ph.D. Natural Resource Economics

- **Fields:** Urban & Regional Economics, Natural Resource & Environmental Economics
- **Dissertation Title:** “Three Essays on Local Labor Markets”

West Virginia University

August 2020

B.S. Environmental & Natural Resource Economics

Minor, Statistics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Urban and Regional Economics, Labor Economics, Rural Economic Development, Policy Analysis

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

Hoffer, Adam J., Brad R. Humphreys, **David H. Nason**, Joseph Nedved, and Amir B. Ferreira Neto.

“Sports Betting, Lotteries, and State Revenues in the Post-PASPA Era” [Link to Working Paper](#).

Forthcoming at *Public Finance Review*

Dobis, Elizabeth A., **David H. Nason**, John Cromartie and Kyle Reed. “Rugged terrain measures for

social science research: Applying the Area and Road Ruggedness Scales to counties” *Agricultural and*

Resource Economics Review 54, no. 1 (April 2025): 243–59. <https://doi.org/10.1017/age.2025.12>.

REPORTS

Pipa, Anthony F., Heather M. Stephens, **David H. Nason** and Zoe Swarzenski (2025). “Unlocking

Investment in Distressed Rural Places: Comparing the Infrastructure Funding of Select Federally

Chartered Regional Commissions Versus Federal Programs” *The Brookings Institution*. [Link to Report](#)

Higgins, J., **David H. Nason**, and John Shannon. “Commuting Patterns in Southwest Florida.” *FGCU*

Regional Economic Research Institute Issue Brief (IBS-2025-06). [Link to Report](#)

UNDER REVIEW

Nason, David H., Adam Scavette, and Heather M. Stephens. “The Local Economic Effects of Coal

Mine Closures”. [Link to Working Paper](#). Under Review at *Journal of Urban Economics*

Li, Xioayin, **David H. Nason**, and Heather M. Stephens “Skill-based Occupational Connectivity and Local Labor Market Development”. [Link to Working Paper](#). Under Review at *Regional Science and Urban Economics*

Shannon, J., **David H. Nason**, and Amir B. Ferreira Neto. “Economic Contribution of Natural Amenity Supported Tourism in Southwest Florida”. Under Review at *Journal of Outdoor Recreation and Tourism*

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

Li, Xioayin, **David H. Nason**, and Heather M. Stephens “Can Local Labor Market Structure Help Absorb Technological Shocks? Evidence from AI Exposure and Occupational Connectivity”.

Nason, David H. “Evaluating the Impact of Place-Based Jobs Policies in Distressed Areas”. [Link to Working Paper](#).

Nason, David H. and Heather M. Stephens. “The Spatial Distribution of Skills and Local Labor Market Resilience” [Link to Working Paper](#)

Nason, David H. “Local Labor Market Effects of Changes in Employer Skill Demand”. In Prep.

RESEARCH GRANTS

“Assessing the Economic Effects of ARC’s Investments in Appalachia”. Appalachian Regional Commission grant. Co-investigator. Funding: \$134,174. Timeframe: September 2026 – August 2027.

PRESENTATIONS

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| 2026 | Association for University Business and Economic Research Fall Conference
73rd Annual North American Meetings of the Regional Science Association International
2026 Northeast Housing Summit |
| 2025 | Southern Regional Science Association 64th Annual Conference
Association for University Business and Economic Research Fall Conference |
| 2024 | 71st Annual North American Meetings of the Regional Science Association International
Southern Regional Science Association 63rd Annual Conference
Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association Workshop, Discussant |
| 2023 | 70th Annual North American Meetings of the Regional Science Association International
Southern Regional Science Association 62nd Annual Conference |
| 2022 | Mid-Continent Regional Science Association 52nd Annual Conference
West Virginia University Davis College Student Research and Creative Scholarship Day |

AWARDS AND HONORS

- 2024 NAREA Workshop Travel Award for Early Career Scholars
2023 Farm Foundation Agricultural Scholar

JOURNAL REFEREE

Agricultural and Resource Economics Review

RELEVANT RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

West Virginia University
Regional Research Institute
Graduate Research Assistant

January 2023 - May 2024
August 2024 - May 2025

United States Department of Agriculture
Economic Research Service
Economist Intern (Full-Time)

May 2024 - August 2024

West Virginia University
Division of Resource Economics and Management
Graduate Research Assistant to Dr. Heather Stephens

July 2021 - December 2022

West Virginia University
Division of Resource Economics and Management
Graduate Research Assistant to Dr. Ana Claudia Sant'Anna

August 2020 - June 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Principles of Microeconomics
Co-Instructor, Intro to Environmental and Natural Resource Economics

Spring 2026
Fall 2022

TECHNICAL SKILLS

R, Python, STATA, QGIS, ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine, IMPLAN

PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

American Economic Association, North American Regional Science Council, Southern Regional Science Association, Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association, Agricultural and Applied Economics Association